

Seasons of Rose's

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Our Main Characters:

 Rose – (The Mother)

 Throne – (The Father)

 Lilian (Lili) – Pride

 Violet – (Viola) Wrath

 Marigold (Mari)– Lust.

 Ivy – Envy

 Dahlia – Sloth Twin#1

 Camellia – Greed Twin#2:

 Zinnia – Gluttony

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Chapter 1: The Day He Left

The cottage stood by the lake, surrounded by green fields. The air smelled of fresh grass and wildflowers. Inside the small wooden house, seven little girls sat close to their mother, Rose. She was young, but sorrow had made her face look older. Her hands, rough from work, rested on her lap. The youngest child, only a baby, lay asleep in her arms.

Rose had once been full of dreams. She had married young, believing in love, believing that she and her husband would build a happy life together. Her husband, Thorne, was a carpenter, a man of strong hands and high hopes use his mind much more than his heart and his emotions. But he had only one true dream which was to have a son, a boy to carry his name, to learn his craft and to be his pride.

Rose wanted to give him that. Each time she carried a child, she whispered to the heavens, "Let it be a boy this time." But each time, a daughter was born. She loved her girls with all her heart, but she saw the disappointment in her husband's eyes. He grew colder, distant. He stopped holding her, stopped looking at her the way he once did. And when their seventh daughter came into the world, he said nothing. He stood at the doorway, watching as the baby cried in her mother's arms.

The next morning, he packed his things and walked away. He didn't even say goodbye. He left behind his small workshop, his tools untouched, the scent of wood still fresh. The girls watched him go, their young minds not fully understanding what it meant. But Rose understood. He had given up on them. On her. He left!! Rose, with every bit of love she had. But love had not been enough. Rose had been beautiful, gentle, and hopeful once, but she had married a man who saw her not as a partner, but as a means to an heir. And when she bore him only daughters, he turned away, leaving behind nothing but bitterness and an empty place at the table.

She looked at her daughters' face, one by one. Lilian, the eldest, clenched her fists. Marigold holding her mother's arm, whispering ,Ivy, beside her, lowered her head. Violet's eyes burned with anger. Dahlia held her sister's hand, silent. Camellia stared at the door, as if waiting for him to return. Zinnia too young to understand, sucked on her thumb.

Rose knew she had to be strong. She kissed her baby's forehead and her tears dropped down her face.

Chapter 2: Life Goes On

Years passed, and with every changing season, their home transformed painted with golden autumn leaves, chilled by winter's cold breeze, and brought to life by the soft blossoms of spring. Time moved forward, shaping Rose's daughters, their hearts growing restless, each one carrying a longing they didn't yet understand.

Rose, as she did every day, returned from the farm, her hands carrying fresh vegetables from their garden. Marigold had accompanied her, though her real reason for going was something else entirely. She often slipped away, vanishing behind the trees by the lake to meet a boy in secret, lost in reckless desires she barely understood. When she noticed the time, she rushed back, catching a few fish from the lake to avoid suspicion. Breathless, she ran toward her mother, hoping she wouldn't notice her absence.

As they entered the house, Rose called out, "Lili! Come cook the food. Your sister helped me bring it in; now it's your turn to do your part. Where is this girl!!"

Before Lili could answer, Violet said while her voice dripping with mockery. "She's probably in front of the mirror, daydreaming."

Lilian—or Lili, as they called her—was beautiful, confident, and ambitious. She dreamed of a glamorous life in the city, a world she had only glimpsed through the stories of her cousin, who visited from time to time. Their uncle, Rose's older brother, often came to check on them, pitying his abandoned sister and her daughters. Lili clung to those visits, to the magazines her cousin brought her, filled with elegant women and shimmering gowns.

She sighed dramatically. "Yes, Mother, I'm coming! Let me just throw myself into the kitchen and drown in the smell of onions and fish! But remember this I won't always be here. One day, I'll be a famous model. I'll have a chef to cook for me, and I'll never have to smell fish, onions, or tomatoes again!" She tossed the magazine onto her bed and stomped toward the kitchen, frustration in her every step.

Rose shaking her head. "Where is Ivy?" she asked.

Ivy was nowhere to be seen, but that was typical. She was the quiet one, always watching, always comparing. Whether it was Lili's beauty, Marigold's effortless charm over the village boys, or even Dahlia's carefree spirit!

Meanwhile, outside in the workshop, Violet sat among the tools and wooden scraps left behind by their father. She had spent years sneaking into the shop, reading books on carpentry, sharpening her skills in secret. She didn't need a father to teach her she would learn on her own. She wanted to push her sisters towards her goal to prove that we girls can do what the boy that her father dreamt of and left them for but she was so scary for her sisters to listen! She was always angry and her temper was too short to support, teach or push her sisters to do the right thing so she chose to do it alone! And spend most of her time in her father's workshop!

The noise from the house grated on her nerves. With an exasperated sigh, she stormed inside. "What is all this noise? I'm trying to work!"

Rose turned to her sharply, snatching the book from her hands. "You're always yelling, Violet. Instead of arguing, why don't you help us?"

She tossed the book toward Dahlia, who had been lying on the sofa, half-asleep. It landed on her stomach with a soft thud, making her groan.

"And you!" Rose's voice was stern. "Didn't you get enough sleep? Get up and do something! Help in the kitchen, feed the chickens at least step outside and see some sunlight!"

Dahlia, said while stretching lazily. "Alright, alright... but give me money to buy chicken feed."

Rose Asked. "What do you mean? I bought feed just yesterday."

Dahlia hesitated before answering, "Camellia took it this morning to sell it to some farmer near the school and take the money and added to the money that you already daily give to her."

Rose's expression darkened. "What?" Her gaze turned toward Camellia, who had just walked through the door, the very picture of innocence.

Violet snorted. "Mother, don't you know by now? Camellia's greed is endless."

Camellia had an eye for beautiful things dresses, gold and money. She wanted more. Always more of anything and everything.

Rose grabbed her daughter's arm, not harshly, but firmly. "Tell me, you greedy little fox, why did you sell the chicken feed? I give you money every day when you go to school just as your sisters, why wasn't it enough?"

Camellia crossed her arms, her lip jutting out. "I needed more," she said simply.

Rose narrowed her eyes. "And what did you buy?"

Camellia hesitated before pulling a small bag from her pocket. "Chicken feed," she said, but the moment Rose opened the bag, she scowled.

"This is cheap, low-quality feed. Take it back and get the proper one, or I swear, I will feed you to the chickens myself!"

At the dining table, they finally gathered to eat, but the peace did not last. Zinnia arrived late, clutching her stomach.

"Mom, I got a stomach-ache again. I ate a lot of chocolates at school, I will take some medicine and come to eat with you!"

Rose sighed, shaking her head. "Zinnia, how many times must I tell you stop eating everything in sight! Take your medicine, change your clothes, and come eat properly."

Zinnia had an endless love for food and comfort. She lived for the next bite, the next taste. But sometimes, she didn't know when to stop.

As the night settled in, the sisters sat together, each lost in their own thoughts. They were growing, changing, but still tangled in their flaws. The future was waiting. And whether they liked it or not, life was about to teach them its hardest lessons.

But for now, they were just girls..girls standing at the edge of their futures.

Chapter 3: The Taste of Envy

The morning sun bathed the cottage in golden light as Lili sat by the window, brushing her long, sleek hair. Watching the golden leaves drift from the trees, she felt the crisp breath of autumn whispering change into the world.

The reflection in the glass showed her deep brown eyes filled with dreams she had yet to chase. She longed for a life beyond their simple home, a life of beauty, admiration, and luxury.

Her cousin Farida arrived that afternoon, her cane tapping softly against the wooden floor as she walked in. Farida had always been a source of wisdom, despite the limp that made her movements slower. She sat beside Lilian, a gleam in her eyes.

"Lili, there's a competition," she began, her voice filled with excitement. "The most beautiful girl in the country will be chosen as the face of the biggest fashion brand. The winner gets money, fame, and a future beyond anything we've imagined."

Lilian's heart pounded. "A competition???? I have to take this chance"

"Of course! You're stunning, Lili. You just need to believe in yourself. I would have joined if... well, you know," Farida said, tapping her leg lightly. "But you can do it. You must."

Excitement bubbled in Lilian's chest. This was her chance to escape their small town and prove she was meant for more. The only obstacle was convincing her mother.

With Farida's father, speaking on her behalf, Rose hesitated but finally agreed under one condition. "You will return home the moment it's over. No matter the outcome, even if you win no working with famous brands and no living in the city and leaving the house" she said firmly.

Lilian nodded eagerly. "I promise, Mama. I'll go, compete, and come back. But I know this is my first step toward something greater!"

Ivy stood at the doorway, unseen, watching. Her hands curled into fists. Why Lili? Why was she the lucky one? It should have been her. The jealousy burned, spreading through her veins like poison. That night, an idea crept into her mind, a dangerous idea Full of Envy and Evil.

The next morning, Ivy approached Lili with a bright smile, holding a small box.

"Sister, I want to help you win," Ivy said sweetly, handing over the box. "This is a secret beauty recipe. Ten spoons a day, and your skin will glow while burning away all extra weight."

Lili hesitated. "Are you sure?"

"Of course! Trust me, Lili. I want you to shine and win this competition."

Satisfied, Lili took the box, unaware of her sister's evil inside.

But someone else had been watching, guess who?

Yes, the food magnet; Zinnia., her love for food was endless. That night, while Lili slept, Zinnia snuck into her sister's room, her stomach growling. Curiosity and gluttony overpowered her, and she opened the box. A rich, creamy scent filled the air. Unable to resist, she scooped out spoonful after spoonful, devouring every bit of it.

Hours later, a scream pierced the silence.

Rose rushed to Zinnia's side, finding her clutching her stomach in agony. The doctor arrived quickly, inspecting the empty box.

"What in heaven's name is this?" he asked. Rose explained what Ivy had told Lili. The doctor shook his head and chuckled. "Slimming formula? This is a disaster in a box! Butter, sugar, flour everything that makes someone gain weight rapidly. Who told you this nonsense?"

Lili turned to Ivy, realization dawning on her face. "You lied to me? You wanted to ruin me?"

Ivy stammered, unable to deny it. Tears welled up in Lili's eyes as she ran to her room, locking the door.

Meanwhile, Zinnia's punishment came in the cruelest form. The overdose of rich food had damaged her system. The doctor delivered the verdict: diabetes. "She will need a strict diet for the rest of her life. No more sweets, no more indulgence. If she doesn't control her food, she could lose her health completely."

Zinnia sobbed, realizing that what she did had stolen from her the very thing she loved most.

That night, Rose sat beside Lili, gently stroking her hair. "I don't want your heart to be filled with any hatred towards your sister, Ivy's actions came from her

own pain, not your trust in her. Remember, true beauty comes from the inside and the most beautiful trait that you can have inside you is forgiveness."

In the other room in the dim glow of the lantern, Ivy sat curled up in the corner of her room, knees pulled to her chest. She had heard the whispers outside her mother's voice, Lili's crying and Zinnia got sick after eating the mix that was made of her evil. Guilt pressed down on her, heavier than she had ever felt before. When the door creaked open, she looked up to see Rose standing there, her face calm yet filled with quiet disappointment.

Rose walked inside and sat down beside Ivy, wrapping a gentle arm around her. For a while, she said nothing. Just the steady warmth of a mother's embrace.

"Ivy," Rose finally spoke, her voice soft but firm. "Tell me, my child, why did you do it?"

Ivy swallowed hard, unable to put her eyes in her mother's face. "I just..." she hesitated. "I just wanted to feel like I was enough. Lili always shines. She's always admired. And I ... I feel invisible beside her."

Rose sighed, brushing Ivy's hair behind her ear. "Do you know how envy begins, my love? It starts as something small, something that feels harmless. 'I just want to be better,' you tell yourself. But then it grows. It whispers that someone else's beauty or success means there is less for you. And before you know it, you stop seeing your own worth."

Ivy's eyes welled with tears. "But I don't feel special, Mama. Lili is beautiful. She has everything. What do I have?"

Rose cupped Ivy's face in her hands and tilted her chin up. "No one in this world is exactly like you, Ivy. No one can bring to the world what you bring. Allah made a miracle with our differences. If He wanted us all the same, He would have made us so. But He didn't. He gave each of us something unique, something that no one else has."

Ivy sniffled. "But what if my gift isn't good enough?"

Rose smiled. "What makes a flower beautiful, Ivy? Is it just the petals? Or is it the way it grows, the way it bends toward the light, the way it survives the storms? Some flowers are admired for their colours, but others are loved for their scent, their strength, or the way they heal. Your sister's beauty may be in her face, but yours can be in your heart. In your kindness, your wisdom, your loyalty.

Beauty is not a competition, my dear. It's a gift, one that flourishes when we stop comparing and start embracing who we are."

Ivy wiped her tears, listening intently. Rose continued, her voice carrying a quiet strength. "When you compare yourself to others, you let their light blind you to your own. But when you focus on your own path, you grow in ways you never imagined. Look at Zinnia, her gluttony led her to sickness, just as your envy led you to unbearable guilty feelings. Do you see now? These sins, they aren't just words. They have real consequences."

Ivy nodded slowly, shame and understanding mixing in her heart. "I never wanted to hurt Lili. I just wanted to be seen."

Rose kissed her forehead. "You are always seen, my love. You just need to see yourself. And next time you feel envy creeping in, remember this: No one can be you but you. And that, my dear, is a kind of beauty no one else can ever take away."

Ivy wrapped her arms around her mother, holding onto her tightly. In that moment, she felt something shift within her. The first step towards healing. Towards finding her own light.

Rose, went to check on Zinnia, staring at the plate of bland food she would have to eat for the rest of her life, learned that too much of anything, even pleasure, could turn into a curse!

The first two lessons had been learned.

One by envy, and the other by gluttony. Yet, like the ever-changing seasons, the sisters' journeys were far from over. The winds of autumn carried whispers of regret, winter's frost settled over shaken hearts, but spring would come—bringing growth, renewal, and the chance to bloom once more.

Chapter 4: Hidden Wounds.

Marigold sat beside the lake, her fingers tracing circles in the water as the boy leaned in, his touch familiar yet suddenly unwelcome. Her mind drifted back to the day before, to the small child she had seen giggling in his mother's arms, his tiny hands tangled in her hair as she kissed his forehead. The warmth, the safety, Marigold had never felt anything like it.

Marigold asked in a deep sad voice, can we talk?

A sharp laugh pulled her back. "Mari, it's been three years, and this is the first time we're talking instead of... well, you know."

She felt her cheeks burn. "Yeah... uh, I guess I was just thinking... we'll get married in the end and have kids, right?" Her voice wavered, desperate for reassurance, I just need to know when we can marry and have kids!

The boy chuckled, shaking his head. "Marriage? Kids? No way Mari!!"

Her heart clenched. "Why, don't you love me?"

He Said "Mari, What love!! Okay, you're very weird today and that's scaring me a little bit"

"I loved you!" she said while her tears were drifting.

"A2a2a2a," he teased, deepening her shame. "You love what we do. Maybe now you're realizing you want more."

Marigold's breath caught. The truth in his words cut deeper than she wanted to admit. She glanced at the lake's surface, seeing her reflection, a girl lost, chasing something she mistook for love, she grabbed a rock and hurled it at the water. Ripples distorted her reflection, breaking the illusion she had clung to for so long.

She turned away, leaving him behind. She needed to talk to someone, to escape the suffocating weight of her choices.

Marigold found Viola, she thought it would be so awkward to talk to her mom and her sisters are too young to understand and Lili is too far to listen so she went to Viola.

Viola was sitting on her workbench, her tools clanking against metal as she furiously tried to piece together something or anything that would make sense. Marigold hesitated, her feet barely daring to cross the threshold. "Viola... I need!"

Viola with the usual anger "Not now, Marigold!", her voice sharp as steel. "I have work to do."

Marigold swallowed hard. The anger in her sister's eyes was too much. It had always been too much. With a heavy heart, she turned away, retreating to her room in silence, the loneliness pressing down on her chest.

Rose was watching this scene, and was very angry that the mysterious marigold finally wanted to speak out but unfortunately, she chose Viola, who refused to break any barriers and didn't even give herself a time to look up and see her sister's tears! But Rose was wise enough to be aware that she can't meet anger with anger!

She went to viola and whispered. " Can I talk to you?"

Vola said "Please leave me alone"

Rose replied in a firm way "Would you please leave this workshop for a while and give some time for us, I need you to have some responsibility and help me in taking care of your little sisters?"

Viola sat silently ready to hear her mom.

Rose stepped closer, placing her hand on Viola's shoulder. "You are the oldest now Since Lili is not here, you're their second mom, Viola. I need you to be calmer, to listen, to.."

"To what?" Viola spun around, her eyes wild. "To pretend that I don't feel like what I feel? To wear the same masks you all wear? To ignore the anger boiling inside my heart? The anger that's been there for years and years since he left?"

Rose's heart ached. "Viola, your anger is not what your dad left you. It is what you've chosen to carry."

Viola clenched her fists. "No. He left because I was a girl. If I had been a boy, he would've stayed! If I had been stronger and at least be able to manage this workshop and be in his place but till now I can't"

"No, Viola!" Rose's voice trembled, but her words were firm. "You can't not because you're a girl, you can't because you never asked for help, your father had five assistants in this very workshop. He was strong, yes, but never alone. And yet, you, my brilliant, stubborn girl, have locked yourself in here, fighting a war against yourself. The enemy you see is not him, it's you."

Viola's breath hitched. Her mother's words wrapped around her like a vice, squeezing the air from her lungs. She had spent years drowning in her fury, refusing to reach out, refusing to ask for help where her deep sadness appeared as a scary monster kept her alone it was WRATH!

"Your anger was your enemy, Viola," Rose continued, her voice softer now. "And it has scared everyone away. It has eaten you alive in this workshop. But you don't have to let it. You are not alone, my love."

And for the first time in years, Viola let herself cry!

All Viola's tears that she had held back for years spilled over, her body shaking as she collapsed into her mother's arms. The Winter's cold air of the dimly lit workshop seeped through the wooden walls, but for the first time, Viola wasn't numb to it. The warmth of her mother's embrace thawed something deep inside her, something she had buried beneath years of anger and resentment.

Rose held her, stroking her hair as she whispered, "You are enough, Viola. You have always been enough. Your strength can make you do what men can never do, but don't let the source of your strength be hatred or revenge."

For the first time in years, Viola let herself cry. She cried for the girl she used to be, the girl who believed she had to be tough, to be more than just a daughter, to be something her father would have stayed for. She cried for the love she had rejected, for the warmth she had denied herself. The sound of the wind outside howled through the cracks in the walls, but inside, for the first time, Viola felt safe.

Her mother gently pulled back, cupping Viola's face in her weathered hands, eyes shimmering with unspoken pain and boundless love. "You have a chance now, my child. A chance to start fixing things. But to do that, you must break the barriers you've built. Stop hiding behind your anger. Stop wearing these men's clothes, stop cutting your hair like boys and let it grow ! stop acting as if men's look will make you seem stronger to yourself when you look in the mirror

My Dear, Strength isn't in how you dress or how much you push others away. Strength is in knowing when to fight and when to embrace."

Viola stared at her mother, breath hitching as she looked into the eyes of the woman who had raised seven daughters alone in a world that told her she needed a man. The realization hit her so hard in this very moment.

Her mother had done the impossible. She had stood tall without bitterness, without anger, without ever losing herself. If that wasn't strength, then what was?

Fresh tears welled in Viola's eyes, but this time, they weren't born of rage. They were of understanding. Of acceptance. She wasn't weak for being a woman. She wasn't abandoned because she wasn't enough. She had spent years fighting an enemy that was never real, punishing herself for something that was never her fault.

The snow had begun to fall outside, blanketing the earth in a fresh start. Viola closed her eyes, inhaling deeply. The weight on her shoulders was still there, but it was lighter now. Manageable. And for the first time, she didn't feel alone.

Rose wiped Viola's tears and gave her a small smile. "Now, go check on Mari, your little sister. She asked for your help. That mysterious girl... the dark box she keeps hidden scares me too." She chuckled, trying to lighten the moment.

Viola nodded, breathing in deeply. For the first time, she felt a sliver of clarity, a chance to be more than the storm she had let consume her.

Meanwhile, in the city, Lili sat in the car, watching as towering buildings disappeared into the sky. She was in awe of how they seemed to swim through the clouds, it's very different from the small houses that she used to see in the village, their glass windows reflecting the golden hue of the winter sun.

"Is there a festival today? Why is it so noisy and crowded?" Lili asked, confused by the endless stream of cars and people bustling through the streets.

Frida laughed. "Oh, Lili, this is just a normal day in the city. You're just not used to the crowd and noise. Actually, that's why my dad and I love visiting your quiet house so much."

Lili frowned, feeling an odd sense of contradiction. How could they love what she had always wanted to escape from? And here was the beginning of the plot in Lili's perspective, for the first time, the quiet beauty of her home, the stillness, the familiarity, the warmth. Pride had blinded her from seeing the blessing she had taken for granted.

Frida nudged her playfully. "Come on, cousin. It's only a week until the competition. Let's prepare!"

Frida, with her heart of gold, took it upon herself to help Lili get ready. She made her soothing face masks, taught her beauty tricks, and gave her tips on how to present herself with confidence.

But far from the city's bright lights, in the quiet solitude of Rose's house, Marigold sat curled up in her room, tears staining her cheeks. Shame weighed heavily on her chest as she grappled with the choices that had led her here. How had she let her desires control her? How had she wasted three years of her life in lust without realizing where this path would take her or what it had already taken from her?

A hesitant knock came at her door, followed by Viola's uncertain voice. "Why are you crying?" she asked, stepping into the room. "I'm sorry I've been distant, but I've realized... you matter to me much more than those stupid tools in the workshop."

Mari didn't wait for another word she jumped out of her bed and ran to Viola throwing herself into her sister's arms, sobbing uncontrollably. Viola, unaccustomed to such raw displays of emotion. She was so hesitated before finally placing a careful hand on Mari's back, awkwardly at first, but then with growing warmth as she tried to calm her.

Mari poured out her heart, confessing everything. "Now, I see my mistake," she whispered brokenly. "I just feel so embarrassed... so ashamed."

Viola remained silent, absorbing every word. And in that stillness, something dawned on her, her sister's words make her hate wrath for costing her more than she had ever realized. If only she had been softer, if only she had been there, maybe she could have saved Marigold before she had fallen too deep into her own darkness.

But maybe, just maybe, it wasn't too late.

Holding her sister tighter, Viola murmured, "Don't be so harsh on yourself. What matters is that you've learned. And from now on, I'm here. I won't let you face anything alone again."

Mari, pulling back slightly. "I feel so empty... I need to do something, something that will help me feel better about myself, something to wash away these shameful moments."

Viola tilted her head in thought before a small smile touched her lips. "Well... I could use an assistant in the workshop."

Mari's eyes widened in disbelief. "You? Letting someone else into your workshop?"

Viola chuckled softly. "Yes. And together, we're going to make the best of it."

As Mari wiped the last of her tears, a cold breeze slipped through the slightly open window, carrying with it the scent of frost.

Viola pulled a thick shawl from the chair and draped it over her sister's shoulders.

"Winter is settling in," she murmured. "But even the harshest winters end, Mari. And when they do, the world is born anew."

Mari looked up at her sister, her heart still aching but now carrying a fragile warmth. Outside, the first delicate snowflakes of the season began to drift from the sky, blanketing the earth in quiet promise.

Chapter 5: Double Trouble and a Dog

Winter mornings were a curse. At least, that's what Dahlia believed. The freezing air wrapped around her like chains, dragging her deeper into her bed. "I can't move. My body has frozen. Tell my mother I love her," she whispered dramatically, wrapping the blanket tighter.

Her twin sister, Camelia, stood by the bed, arms crossed. Unlike Dahlia, Camelia had a mission in life collecting as much pocket money as possible.

She squinted at her lazy twin and an idea was born.

"You don't want to go to school?" Camelia asked.

"No. My soul has left my body," Dahlia groaned.

"Perfect. Stay in bed. I'll go... for both of us."

Dahlia peeked out from under the covers. Suspicious.

"Why would you do that?"

Camelia's evil smile stretched ear to ear. "No reason! Just sisterly love! Also, I will collect your pocket money today. Twice the pocket money, double the joy!"

Dahlia gasped. *"YOU THIEF!"*

Camelia shrugged. *"Thief?? okay get up and go to school and enjoy this coldness outside?"*

Dahlia weighed her options. Sleep or justice? Sleep won.

"Fine. But in exchange, let me hide in the dog's house and sleep till school end so that mom won't see me."

Camelia shrugged again. *"Deal. But don't make the dog angry."*

Dahlia waved her off. *"Oh, please. What's he gonna do? File a complaint?"*

Camelia as she was Dahlia's Identical Twin, easily became Dahlia and strolled into school, feeling like a criminal mastermind. She walked up to their mom that morning, smiled innocently, and said,

"Mom, where's my pocket money?"

After receiving hers, she paused dramatically and gasped.

"OH! Sorry Dahlia I forgot you, my baby!"

Mom fell for it. Camelia doubled her earnings in less than five minutes.

"Too easy," she whispered.

But reality slapped her in the face when she realized she had to be TWO people all day.

Dahlia's friends greeted her, expecting their usual sleepy, confused Dahlia. Instead, they got a sharp-eyed, greedy imposter.

"Dahlia! You actually came to school on time??" one friend gasped.

"Who are you and what did you do to our friend?" another whispered.

Camelia, trying to act like Dahlia, yawned aggressively and walked into a wall.

"Ugh. School. So exhausting."

It worked. They believed her.

But soon, chaos erupted.

Camelia had to attend Dahlia's classes and her own. Two schedules. Two teachers. Double the homework.

She ran through the hallways, bumping into students, mixing up subjects..

By the time lunch arrived, Camelia was dead inside.

"This is NOT worth 20 pounds," she muttered.

Meanwhile...

Dahlia, wrapped in blankets, snuggled inside the dog's house, sighed happily.

"Who needs school when you have peace?"

The dog, staring at her, disagreed.

At first, it tolerated her. But after three hours of being pushed to the side, kicked in sleep, and having its tail mistaken for a pillow, it snapped.

"Wait, wait, let's talk about this—AHHH!"

CHOMP.

Dahlia ran out screaming, the dog chasing her, barking furiously.

"I LET YOU SLEEP IN MY BED!" Dahlia yelled.

The dog did not care. He give her an unforgettable bite in her ... yes !

Camelia was just about to pull off the perfect scam until her math teacher suspected her good answers in math, as camelia was very clever in math opposite to her sister who hated numbers, the teacher called on her.

"Dahlia! Tell me your math grades from last year."

Camelia froze.

Sweat dripped.

Brain buffering.

"Ahh... um... I, uh... I can't remember! But I'll go check my reports!"

The teacher squinted.

"Really? Because last year, I personally caught you throwing your reports into the trash."

The entire class GASPED.

Camelia's face: 😊

The teacher said: I knew it was you camelia from the beginning your right answers fail you.

She was dragged to the principal's office. The scam was over.

The Aftermath

Camelia's punishment? She was disqualified from a math competition that had a 500 pounds prize which was more than her pocket money for the entire year.

"My money..." she whispered, tears of greed falling.

And for Dahlia's punishment?

Here it is,

Dahlia saying to her punished twin camelia *"I can't sleep."*

"Because of guilt?"

"No. Because every time I close my eyes, I see the dog running after me." And they both cried..

And so, the Great Twin Pocket Money Heist ended in humiliation and dog trauma.

The lesson?

Camelia learned that greed leads to suffering.

And Dahlia?

Well, she just learned to never mess with a sleepy dog.

Chapter 6: Pride and Prejudice

Lili had always believed that beauty was her ultimate weapon. With her striking features, graceful posture, and an air of effortless elegance, she was certain she would win the upcoming competition. She had Frida to thank for preparing her and teaching her how to walk, how to dress, how to command attention. But when it came to the intellectual part of preparation, Lili dismissed it entirely.

"Books? General knowledge? Science?" Lili scoffed. "Frida, you know me very well I already hate studying, I'm entering a beauty competition, not a quiz show. My beauty speaks for itself."

Frida sighed. "Lili, we don't read books only for school quizzes, we read books for knowledge besides, they will ask you questions. So please understand me, minds matter too."

"Oh, please! Confidence is intelligence. Watch me, Frida. I was born to win."

Frida frowned but let the matter rest. Lili was far too consumed by her own arrogance to listen.

The competition lasted three days, each round filtering contestants until only one would remain. Lili and Frida arrived at the venue, stepping into a huge scene of chaos. Half-dressed contestants rushed past, stylists and makeup artists frantically worked their magic, and nerves ran high.

Lili stood frozen, absorbing the scene.

"Why are you just standing there?" snapped an organizer, pulling her toward a stylist. "Go! Get ready!"

Before she knew it, she was wrapped in a stunning gown, her makeup flawless, her hair cascading in perfect waves. But most importantly, she was draped in confidence.

She stepped onto the stage like she owned it. The lights bathed her in a celestial glow, the audience held their breath, and a panel of judges kept taking notes about the 10 contestants to choose the four girls that will reach the semi-finals. It was no surprise when Lili advanced to the semi-finals.

"Lili, I'm so happy! This means you can win!" Frida beamed.

Lili scoffed. "Can win? Frida, I *will* win."

Frida chuckled nervously. "Yes, dear, but we still need to prepare. Did you read the books?"

Lili waved a dismissive hand. "No, no. Tomorrow, I will."

She had no intention of doing so.

On the second day, the contestants were each assigned private rooms. As Lili waited for her stylist, an unexpected visitor entered. An old woman with worn-out clothes and a terrible scent stood at the door.

"Excuse me, dear," the woman said softly. "I am so hungry. Could you spare some food?"

Lili recoiled. "Who let you in here? Where's security?"

The woman's face fell. "I will go, but please, just a little something to eat"

Disgusted, Lili pushed her away saying "Go away, you smell awful!!" and ran to call security. But by the time she returned, the woman was gone.

Brushing off the odd encounter, Lili prepared for the second stage a dazzling catwalk. She stole the show with her mesmerizing elegance.

Then came the questions to one of the contestants her name was Jamila, a stunning North African contestant with deep brown skin that shimmered under the lights, was asked about her passions. Her heartfelt answers revealed wisdom, resilience, and kindness. Despite outdated beauty standards regarding skin colour, her radiance was undeniable, her charm, her kindness, her infectious confidence made her breathtaking.

The next contestant, a very cute girl with the warmest smile, spoke of self-love and perseverance. Her curves, once deemed unconventional in the modelling world, became her strength. She stood tall, unshaken, embracing her uniqueness.

And then, it was Lili's turn.

She answered the first two questions smoothly, crafting responses that mirrored the warmth of the other contestants. But then came the final question.

"If a poor woman came to you asking for food, what would you do?"

Lili laughed. "That's the question? Oh, please, we were all raised to help the less fortunate. Of course, I would help her."

A murmur swept through the crowd.

Then, from the audience, a figure stepped forward.

Lili's heart dropped.

The dishevelled woman she had dismissed removed her tattered cloak, revealing an elegant gown beneath it. The room fell silent as gasps filled the air.

"No, Lili," the woman said, her voice smooth and refined. "You have yet to *practice* what you were raised to do."

Lili's face burned with shame. "Y-you're..."

"Miss Valeria," the woman introduced herself, her name rolling off her tongue with an air of authority. She was the CEO of the modelling company. The very woman who owned this event.

Lili stood speechless.

"I went undercover to see how contestants would treat someone in need. And I am sad to say, you have failed."

The final three names were announced. Lili's was not among them.

Tears pricked her eyes as she watched another contestant take her place a girl who had given the disguised Valeria a sandwich and money, leading her gently to the door so security wouldn't harm her.

Defeated, Lili turned to leave, but then the unexpected happened.

"Wait," the newly selected finalist spoke into the mic. "I have university exams. I cannot stay."

The audience erupted into whispers.

The judges deliberated before announcing, "Lili will take her place in the finals."

Lili was back in the game.

Lili took a deep breath full of relief!

She returned home with Frida, emotions churning inside her.

"Frida," Lili whispered. "Help me study."

Frida smiled. "I told you, beauty isn't everything."

Lili snapped, "Frida, I have no energy for your wisdom and annoying advice. If you were so wise, why didn't you take care when riding that horse and losing your leg?"

Silence.

Frida's face paled. She swallowed hard, forcing back tears. Lili immediately regretted her words.

"Frida, I'm so sorry," she whispered. "I'm just nervous."

Frida clenched her jaw, holding back the pain. "It's okay," she said, her voice barely above a whisper. "I'll help you."

An uneasy silence settled between them. That night, Lili finally opened her books, but nothing made sense. She was drowning in information, overwhelmed and lost.

Then, Frida placed a neatly written paper in front of her.

"Here," she said softly. "These are the most likely questions. I wrote down the answers for you."

Lili's eyes filled with gratitude as she hugged Frida tightly.

The next morning, with her pride almost shattered and a newfound determination, she began to prepare not just for the final round, but for something far more important.

She was about to learn the true meaning of beauty.

The moment had arrived the final decision. Who would be crowned the beauty queen? Who would win the title, the prize, and the admiration of all? The three finalists had passed every phase, proving their grace and beauty. But now, it was time for the true test their minds.

Each contestant faced five questions. Lili answered the first four correctly, and so did Jamila However, the third girl faltered on the fourth question, leaving only Lili and Jamila in the running for the crown.

As they took a break before the final round, Lili rushed to her cousin, Frida, bubbling with excitement.

"I won! I won! I won!" she exclaimed, breathless with joy.

Frida smiled warmly but reminded her, "Yes, dear, but there's still one more girl left."

Lili scoffed, rolling her eyes. "Oh, Frida, are you serious? She's black! Have you ever heard of a black beauty queen? What if the lights go out? No one will find her!"

Frida's smile faded. She didn't laugh. Instead, she looked at Lili with disappointment. "That's enough," she said firmly. "Go and prepare yourself."

Lili shrugged, still basking in her confidence. "I'm the queen. They're all just waiting for their queen."

But perhaps the universe had another lesson in store for her.

She was supposed to be on stage at 7:00 p.m., but she intended to arrive at 7:10 out of arrogance, pride and prejudice towards Jamila's skin color. The judges frowned at her tardiness, unimpressed.

"Lili, why are you late?" one of them asked sternly.

"Apologies," she replied, feigning humility. "I was preparing myself."

Deep inside, she knew the truth she wasn't preparing for the competition; she was preparing for her coronation. She had already imagined the crown on her head.

And so, the final moment arrived. Lili and Jamila stood as the last two contestants. The final question was asked by one of the judges and it was about motherhood and the question was: "If a baby was crying, how would you soothe them?" he added "I chose this topic and this question since both of you have a lifestyle of a second mother Lili an elder sister for 6 little sisters living with her mother and the other living with her little brother taking care of him"

Lili hesitated. She had never taken care of a baby before. She tried to remember what she was doing most of her time and found that she has done nothing important in her life rather than looking at the mirror realizing that if she had helped her mother with her younger sisters instead of admiring herself all the time, she might have known the answer. She stood silent while Jamila was heading to the mic to say the answer.

Jamila, smiled and said "After I lost my parents in an accident, I became the mother to my little brother. When he was a baby and cried, I would..." She gave a heartfelt answer, one filled with love and real-life experience.

And with that, Jamila was crowned the winner.

Lili was shocked, sad, and ashamed. Frida held her hand. "No problem my dear, you tried. You're still a beauty queen in my eyes".

Lili turned to her cousin, tears welling in her eyes. "No, Frida," she whispered. "You forgave me for my mean attitude and my stupid mindset. You supported me, tolerated my arrogance, my selfishness. And I didn't realize until now that I was... pretty ugly on the inside."

It was a harsh lesson, but one she needed to learn.

When she returned home, she faced her family with a newfound humility. "I didn't win the competition," she admitted, "but I won something far greater a lesson that will stay with me forever. I now understand that confidence without kindness is arrogance, that beauty without a good heart is nothing more than an empty shell. I once believed my reflection in the mirror was my greatest asset, but I was blind, so blind to the love that surrounded me, blind to the strength of our mom that raised us by her own and I just dismissed it, blind to the richness of a home filled with warmth, laughter, and unconditional love.

I thought I deserved admiration simply for how I looked, yet I never stopped to admire the ones who truly mattered, my family, who gave me everything without asking for anything in return. I was too consumed by my own vanity to

see the beauty in gratitude, in humility, in the simple acts of love that make a person truly radiant.

And worst of all, I let my pride build walls between me and others, feeding a prejudice I never questioned, believing that worth was measured in appearances alone. But tonight, I saw the truth beauty is not in the face; it is in the mind, the soul, the heart. And I was ugly where it mattered most.

Being away from home, standing on a stage where applause felt empty, I finally realized how rich I had always been. The love of my family, the quiet moments of comfort, the hands that held me up even when I did not deserve it those were the real crowns I had ignored. And for the first time, I see clearly.

I may not have won the title tonight, but I have won something far greater sight, understanding, and a heart no longer chained by pride, arrogance and selfishness.."

Her mother and sisters pulled her into a warm embrace, a reminder of the unconditional love she had taken for granted.

That night, she hung a framed photo of herself with Frida who was her support system and the winner Jamila over her bed, a symbol of growth, of humility, of change. She no longer saw her experience as a loss.

She considered it a true victory.

Chapter 7: Washed Away, Born Anew

That night, while everyone was sleeping, the sky wept with a storm so fierce it seemed the heavens themselves were grieving. Rain pounded against the roof, the wind howled through the trees, and then disaster struck. A deafening crack split the silence as part of the ceiling gave way. Water rushed in, flooding the floors, swallowing their home in chaos. The garden where their mother spent all her time and energy in it to get out of it the best food for her little kids, was nothing but a tangle of drowned roots and broken stems. The chickens screeched in panic, and even their loyal dog whimpered, his little house half-destroyed.

The family woke up in a frenzy. The girls scrambled to push the water outside, their feet slipping on the soaked floor as they worked in the dark, their hands trembling from cold and shock. They covered their heads as best they could, waiting, praying for the storm to end.

By morning, the house stood in ruin. Their mother sat in the middle of it all, silent tears streaming down her face as she took in the wreckage. Her hands trembled as they rested on her lap and by her side, her eyes filled with sorrow.

But this time, Lili didn't just stand there, waiting for someone else to take charge. She stepped forward, kneeling beside her mother, and gently took her hands.

"We will handle it. Don't worry."

A quiet determination filled the air, one that hadn't been there before.

"I'll take Viola and Mari, and we'll fix the ceiling," Lili said, no longer the girl who spent hours in front of the mirror, but someone ready to build, to mend.

"I'll help move the water with Mari," Ivy added, tying her hair back.

"We'll fix the garden," Dahlia and Camelia chimed in. "We'll replant everything and take care of it from the beginning."

Little Zinnia, her face still puffy from sleep, frowned. "What about me?"

Their mother wiped her eyes and managed a small smile. "You'll come with me to fix the chickens' coop and rebuild the doghouse."

Zinnia turned to their dog, who sat miserably in the mud, his fur soaked, his little shelter nothing but broken planks. She crouched beside him, stroking his wet ears. "Don't be sad, Biscuit," she said, giving him an affectionate nudge. "Honestly, Dahlia already half-destroyed your house after sleeping in it 3 days in a row, so don't blame the flood. We'll build you a brand-new, even better one!"

Laughter, soft but real, rippled through the family. Even in the face of ruin, they found warmth in each other.

As the days passed, the family worked tirelessly, their hands raw from labor but their hearts fuller than ever. Brick by brick, beam by beam, they rebuilt not just their home, but their bond, their understanding of each other, their love.

Then, one morning, the sun rose over their little house, casting golden light on what was once a place of ruin but was now a home stronger than before. The warmth of spring followed, breathing life into the land that had once drowned in despair. Tiny green sprouts peeked through the soil, defying the flood that had tried to erase them. Birds sang again in the trees, as if celebrating their resilience. Even the chickens clucked happily in their newly built coop, and Biscuit wagged his tail in approval of his fine new house.

Rose stood in the garden, her fingers brushing over the fresh leaves of the plants that her daughters had replanted. The air smelled of damp earth and new beginnings, the soft warmth of spring kissing her skin after the storm's harsh embrace. She looked around at the house they had rebuilt together, at the trees standing tall despite their battered branches, and at her seven daughters, their laughter weaving through the morning air like music.

The flood had taken much, but it had given them something greater a reminder of their strength, their love, and the unshakable bond they shared.

She watched as Ivy and Mari carried buckets of fresh water to nourish the newly planted garden, while Dahlia and Camelia carefully tended to the delicate seedlings. Zinnia, the youngest, giggled as she chased after the chickens, her tiny hands reaching out to steady their new coop. Viola and Lili worked on the last touches of the repaired ceiling, their hands, once soft and delicate, now strong and steady from working with no-stop in the workshop.

Rose felt a deep warmth fill her chest, a kind of love so vast it made her eyes mist. She had raised seven daughters, seven hearts full of fire, kindness, and

resilience. And now, watching them come together after the storm, she knew they would always have each other, no matter what life brought their way.

She took a deep breath, feeling the weight of the past days lift from her shoulders. The rising sun painted the sky in hues of gold and rose, as if nature itself was celebrating their triumph. The birds sang again, the breeze was no longer cold, and the world felt whole once more.

Rose turned to her daughters, smiling softly.

“This home is not just wood and stone,” she said, her voice warm with pride. “It is built on love. And as long as we stand together, no storm will ever break us.”

Her daughters, touched by her words, ran to her, wrapping their arms around her in a tight embrace. They held onto each other, standing in the garden that had been washed away but was now blooming again just like their hearts, just like their home.

Spring had come, and with it, the love and strength that the flood tried to wash away but instead, it only made them stronger and born anew.

THE END.